

Notice Fairness in Simple Games

We can decide if a game is fair by looking at the rules.

★ Today I am learning to notice fairness in simple games.

Step 2

Kindergarten /
Early Elementary

1. What is fair?

Look at each game. Tick the rule that is fair.

a)



Sharing counters

- Rule 1: Take turns picking one counter.
Rule 2: One player picks two counters every time.

☐ Rule 1 is fair.

☐ Rule 2 is fair.

Why? _____

b)



Spinner game

- Rule 1: Each colour has the same size space.
Rule 2: Red has a bigger space than the others.

☐ Rule 1 is fair.

☐ Rule 2 is fair.

Why? _____

2. Are they fair?

Look at each pair of rules.

Tick ✓ Fair or ✗ Not fair. Then write why.

a) Coin flip game

- Rule A: Each player flips the coin once.
Rule B: One player flips the coin twice.



Fair

Not fair

Why?

☐

☐

b) Board race game

- Rule A: Each player moves one step.
Rule B: One player moves two steps.



Fair

Not fair

Why?

☐

☐

c) Marble draw

- Rule A: Each player picks one marble.
Rule B: One player picks two marbles.



Fair

Not fair

Why?

☐

☐

3. Make it fair.

The games below are not fair.

Change the rule to make the game fair.

a)



One player starts. The other player never gets a turn.

New fair rule:



b)



Red is bigger than the other colours.

New fair rule:



c)



One player gets 5 cards. The other gets 2 cards.

New fair rule:



4. Draw and decide.

Draw a game. Write the rule.

Is the game fair? Tick ✓ Fair or ✗ Not fair.

My rule:

Is it fair?

☐ Fair

☐ Not fair

Why?

5. Think and answer.

a) Why is it important for games to be fair?

b) If a game is not fair, how can someone fix it?



6. Real-life fairness.

Are these situations fair or not fair? Tick ✓ Fair or ✗ Not fair.

Fair

Not fair

a) Everyone in the class gets one turn to roll the dice.

☐

☐

b) Only one person in the family gets to choose the movie every time.

☐

☐

c) In a race, one runner can start 5 steps ahead.

☐

☐

My Learning Check

Circle how confident you feel.



I understand this well.



I need more practice.



I need help.

I used...



talking

☐



drawing

☐



looking

☐



thinking

☐

Today I learned...

One thing I did well: _____

One thing I will improve: _____



Think About It!

Can a game be different and still be fair?

